ERA 6

The Jacksonian Era

1824 – 1840

The Corrupt Bargain · expanded democracy · the rise of Jackson

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did the expansion of democracy and the rise of Andrew Jackson reshape American politics?

KEY TERMS

Corrupt Bargain · universal white male suffrage · spoils system · Second Party System · Tariff of Abominations

ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 4.7 · AMSCO Ch. 4.7

A NEW KIND OF POLITICS

The Rise of Jackson

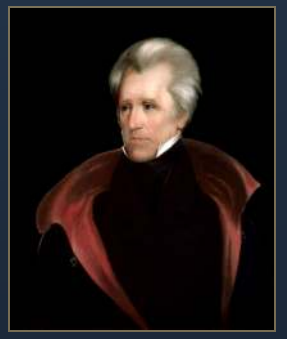
The Election of 1824



John Quincy Adams

Won the presidency

- Finished second in popular and electoral votes.
- No candidate won a majority—so the **House** decided.
- **Henry Clay** threw his support to Adams.



Andrew Jackson

Won the most votes

- Won the most popular and electoral votes—but not a majority.
- Cried foul when Adams made Clay **Secretary of State**.
- Denounced it as a **'Corrupt Bargain.'**

The 'Corrupt Bargain'

VOTE

No Majority

Four candidates split the 1824 vote; none wins a majority.

→

HOUSE

Adams Chosen

The House picks Adams over the front-runner, Jackson.

→

REWARD

Clay Rewarded

Adams names Clay Secretary of State.

→

RESULT

Jackson's Revenge

Furious, Jackson's supporters build a movement for 1828.

SECTION

The Expansion of Democracy

Suffrage Expands



- Before the 1820s, most states limited voting to **property-owning** men.
- New western states granted nearly all white men the vote.
- Older states dropped property requirements to keep pace.

How Democracy Widened

FRONTIER

Western States

New states enter with universal white male suffrage.

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PRESSURE

Older States Follow

Eastern states drop property requirements to compete.

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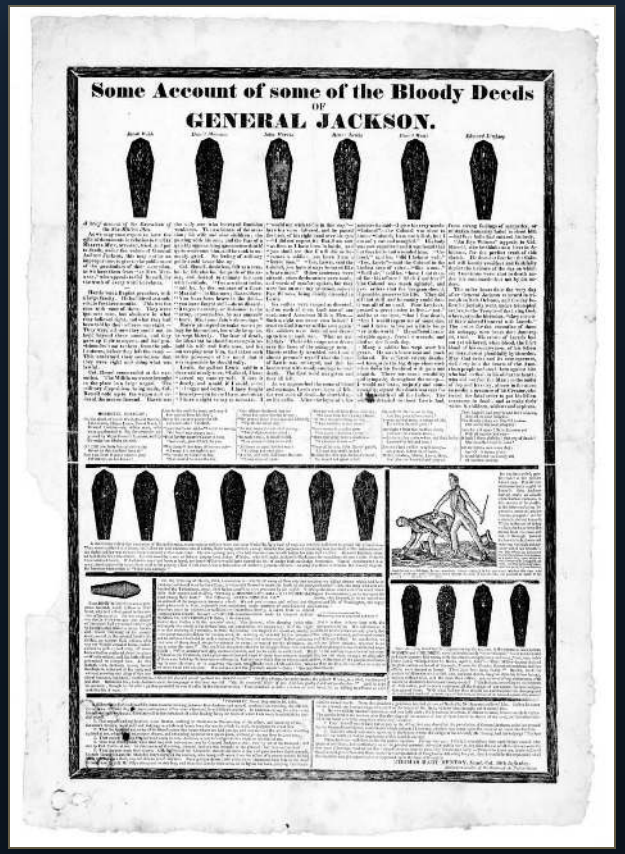
RESULT

The Common Man

By 1828 nearly all white men could vote—and they voted for Jackson.

The Election of 1828

- The rematch was vicious—both sides slung mud (like this anti-**Jackson** 'coffin handbill').
- **Jackson** cast himself as champion of the **common man** against elites.
- He won in a landslide, powered by the newly expanded electorate.



SECTION

The Second Party System

Democrats vs. Whigs

Party competition (1828–1854) energized American politics

	DEMOCRATS	WHIGS
Leader	**Andrew Jackson**	**Henry Clay**
Vision	The '**common man**'; limited federal government	Active government; Clay's American System
Base	Farmers, workers, the South & West	Merchants, reformers, the Northeast
Economy	Against the national bank	For the national bank & tariffs

KEY TAKEAWAYS

The Jacksonian Era

1. The disputed **'Corrupt Bargain'** of 1824 fueled **Jackson**'s rise and the birth of the **Democratic Party**.
2. Expanding **white male suffrage** shifted power toward the '**common man**'—though women, Native Americans, and the enslaved remained excluded.
3. A vibrant **Second Party System**—**Democrats** vs. **Whigs**—reshaped national politics.

DISCUSS & APPLY

The Jacksonian Era

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

CAUSATION

Explain how the expansion of **white male suffrage** changed the way candidates campaigned and won elections.

COMPARISON

Compare the **Democrats** and the **Whigs**. Which party better fit the spirit of the 'common man'?

CONTINUITY & CHANGE

Was 'Jacksonian Democracy' truly democratic? Explain who gained power—and who was still left out.

Up next — **Class 16: Jackson & Federal Power** (the Bank War & Indian Removal)